Find a Friend: **Specialised Cells Activity**

Teacher Instructions

This activity is good for consolidating or checking learning in a plenary or for revision.
Cards can be printed out A4 or A5 and laminated for repeated use.

How to use:

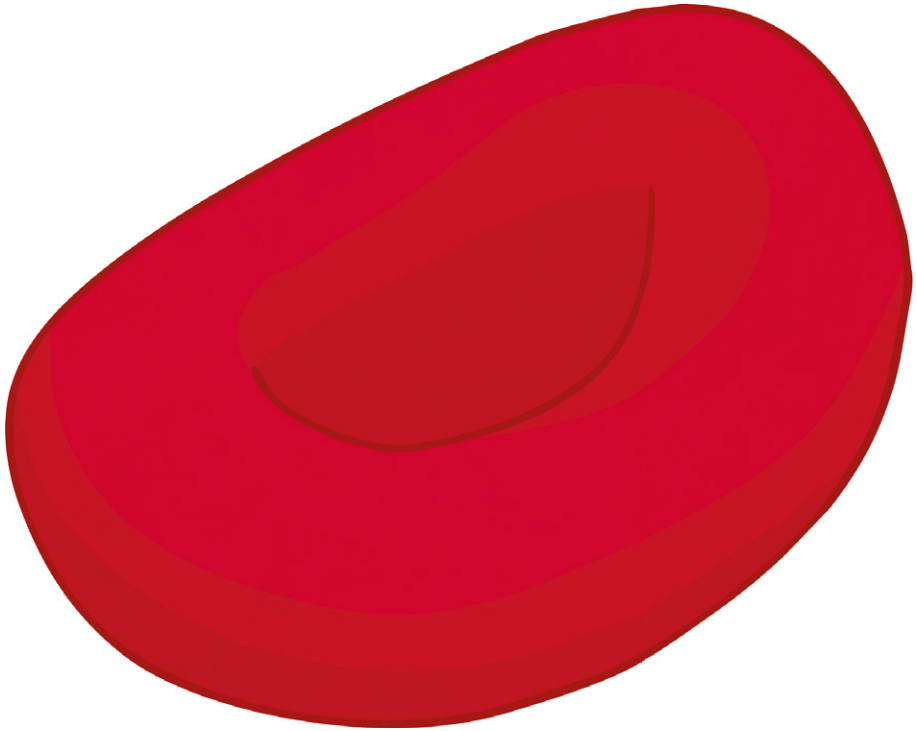
There are 3 types of card:

- orange - diagram (with a part labelled as X);
- blue - name of a part;
- green - description or function of a part.

Give each student in the class one of the cards. This can be random or differentiated by giving easier cards to weaker students and more tricky cards to higher ability students. Unused cards can be put onto a table for students to go to if they can't find their 'friends'. Where there are more students than cards, give one card to a pair of students.

Students should then move around the room and find their two 'friends' with the matching diagram, name and function. This encourages discussion and students that are unsure can get help from their peers.

Once the students have found their friends, the cards can be stuck onto a board, wall or window to form a display that students can refer to if necessary.

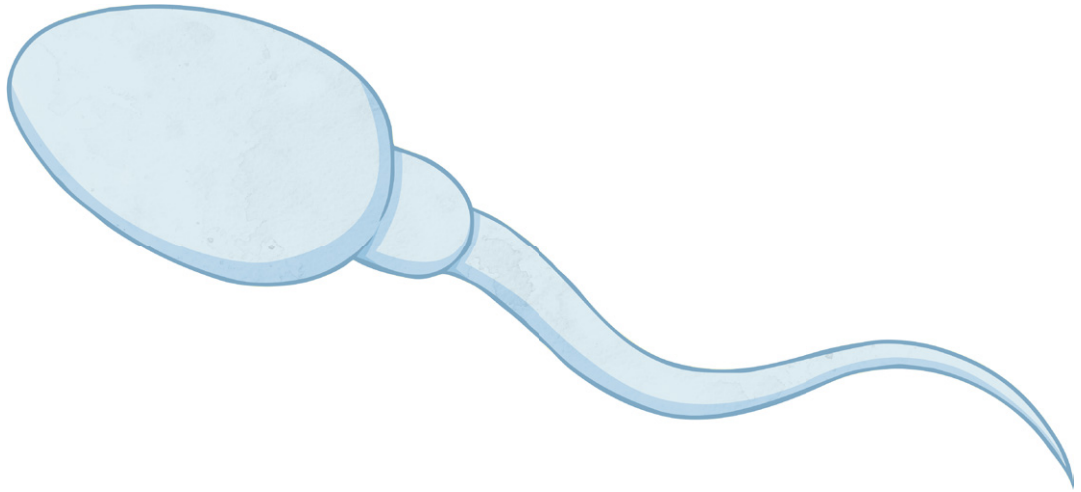


Red blood cell

- Carries oxygen
- Contains haemoglobin (this joins with oxygen)
- No nucleus (so there is more room for haemoglobin)
- Large surface area (so oxygen can be picked up quickly)

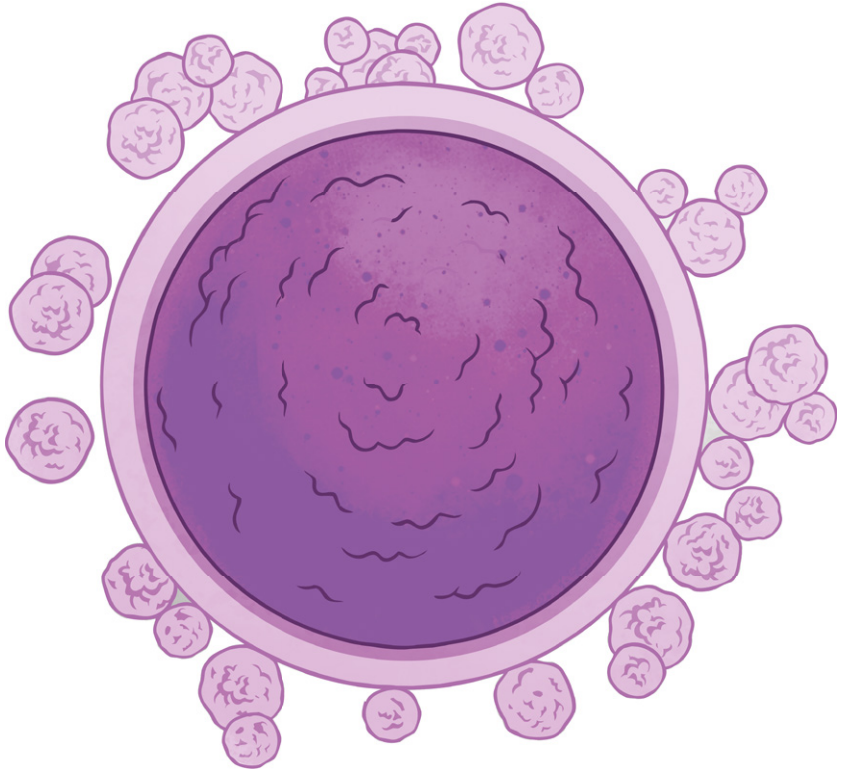
White blood cell (Leukocyte)

- Part of the immune system, kills invading microorganisms
- Can engulf and digest microorganisms
- Can produce antibodies to immobilise microorganisms



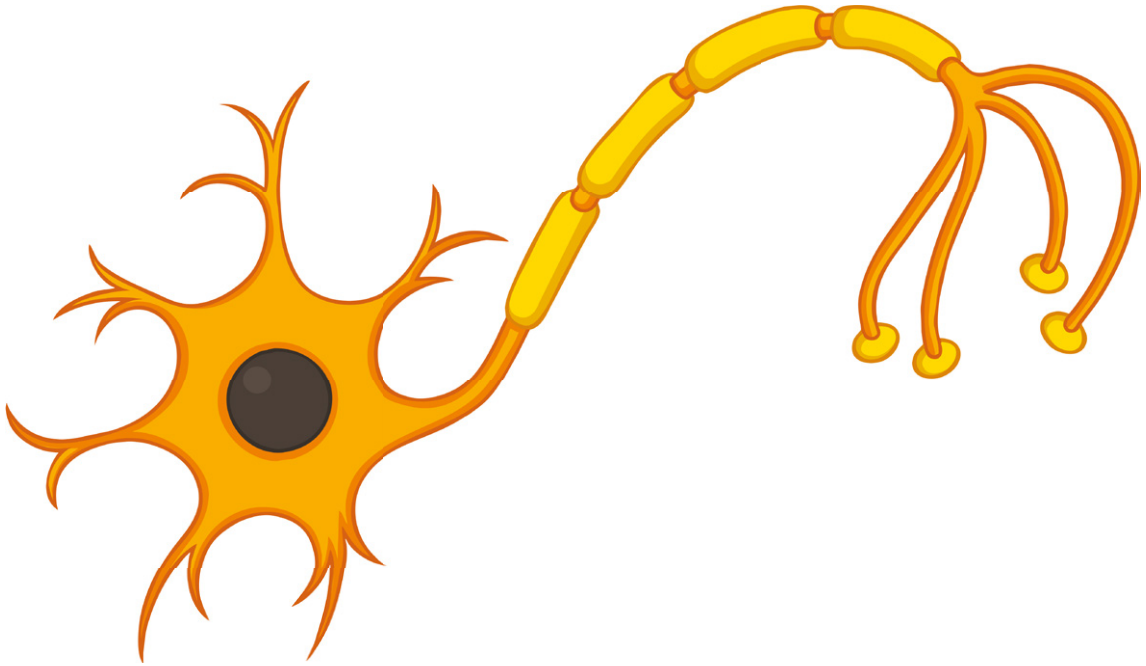
Sperm cell (male gamete)

- Reproduction: Carries the male genetic information (DNA)
- Has a long tail for swimming
- Has lots of mitochondria to provide energy
- Produces chemicals that help it to join with the female egg cell



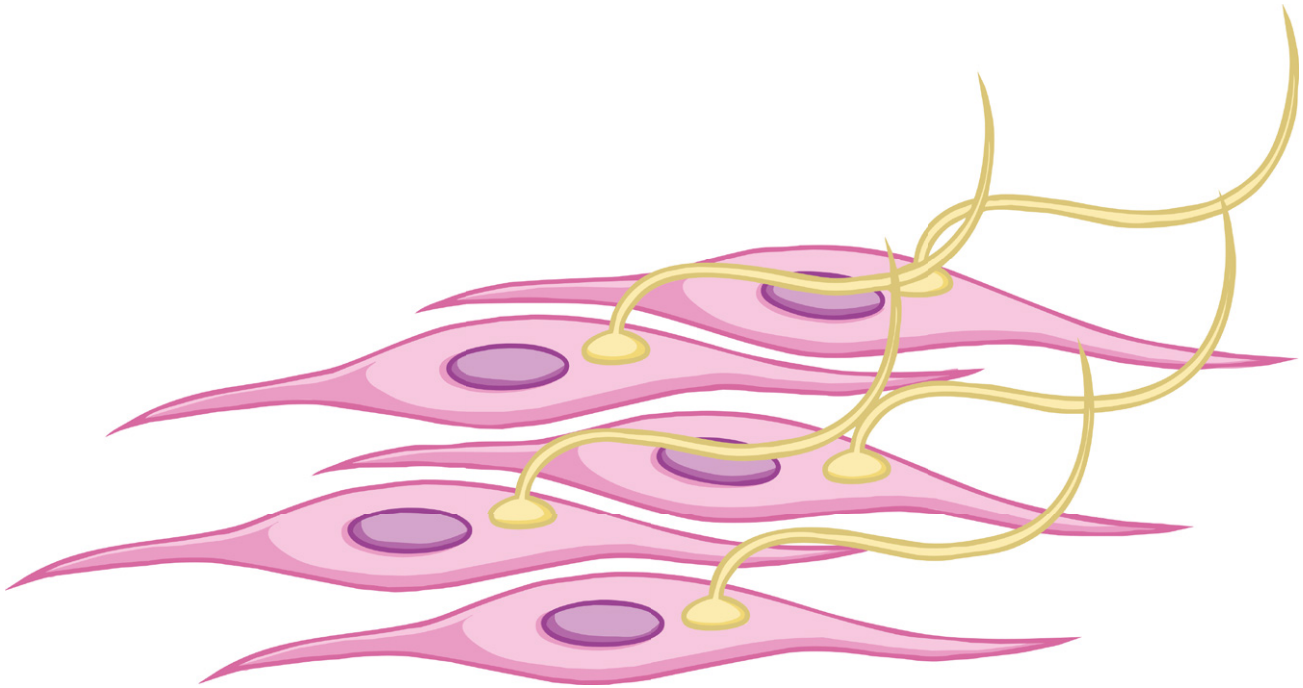
Ovum (egg cell)

- Reproduction: Carries the female genetic information (DNA)
- A large cell, with lots of cytoplasm to provide food for the embryo after fertilisation



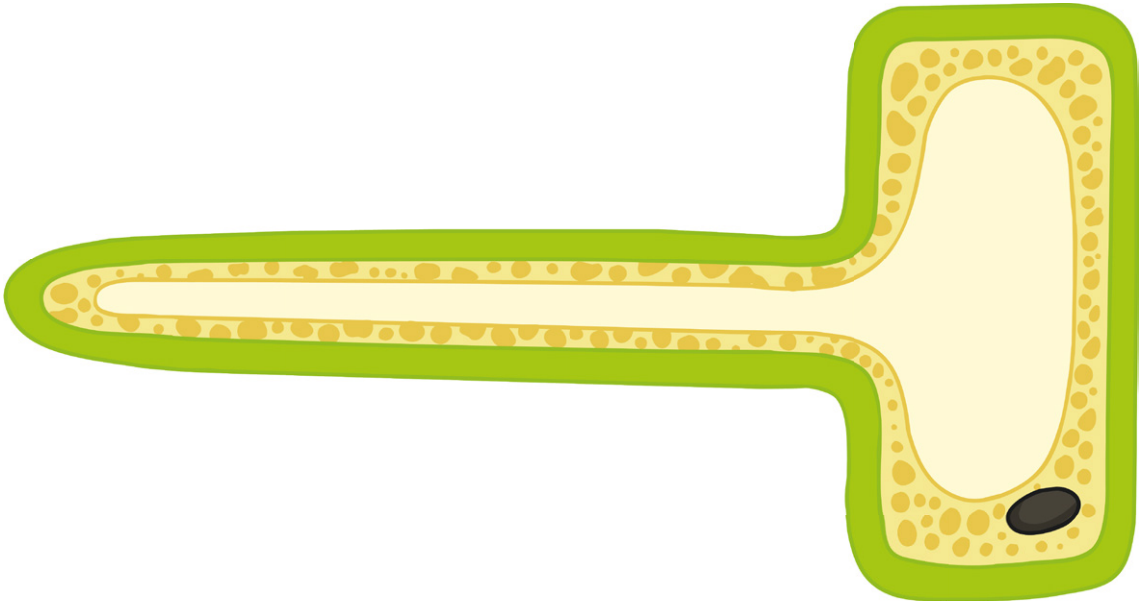
Neurone (nerve cell)

- Part of the nervous system; carries electrical impulses (signals)
- A long cell to carry impulses all around the body
- Lots of connectors (dendrites) at the ends



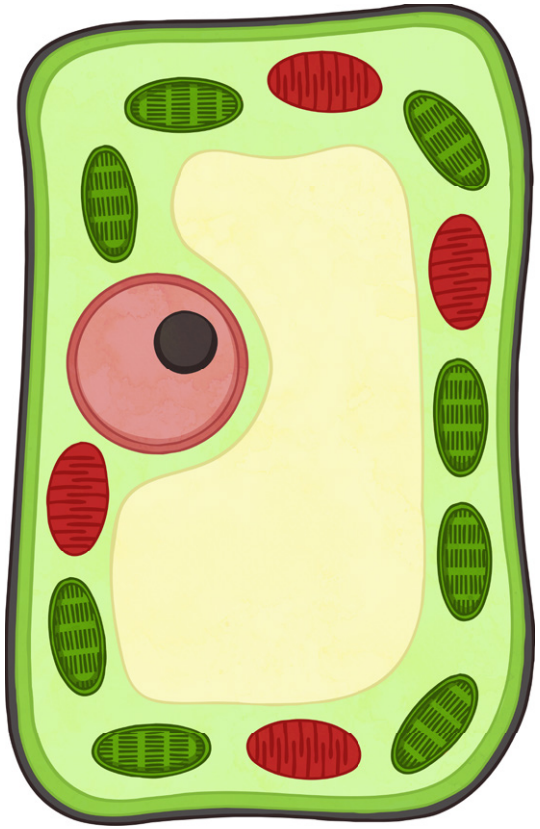
Muscle cell

- Allows us to move
- Can contract and relax
- Has lots of mitochondria to provide energy



Root hair cell

- To absorb water and minerals
- Has a large surface area so water and minerals can be taken up quickly



Palisade cell

- To carry out photosynthesis
- Large surface area and many chloroplasts to absorb lots of sunlight